Performing a Cycle Count Using a Honeywell CK65 Scanner

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CIS311 – Technical Writing in CIS

Unit 5.1 Assignment: Creating and Refining Technical Instructions

Purpose

These instructions explain how to perform a cycle count using a Honeywell CK65 scanner in a warehouse environment. A cycle count is a process used to verify that the physical inventory in a storage location matches the quantity recorded in the Warehouse Management System (WMS).

Required Equipment

Before beginning, ensure you have the following:

- Honeywell CK65 scanner
- Access to the Warehouse Management System (WMS)
- Assigned cycle count location
- Inventory available for counting

Important: Do not move inventory before or during the count. Count only the inventory physically present in the assigned location.

Cycle Count Process Flowchart

Start

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Log into CK65 Scanner and Open WMS

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Select Cycle Count Menu

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Scan Assigned Location Barcode

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Scan LPN Barcode

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Physically Count Inventory

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Enter Quantity into Scanner

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Submit Count

↓

Quantity Matches?

↙ Yes No ↘

Count Accepted (No) Recount Item and Notify Supervisor

↓

Next Count

↓

End

Flowchart showing the cycle count process using a Honeywell CK65 scanner. The flowchart provides a visual overview of the steps required to complete a cycle count and the actions to take when inventory discrepancies are identified.

Technical Terms

Cycle Count: A scheduled inventory verification process used to confirm inventory accuracy without shutting down warehouse operations.

WMS (Warehouse Management System): Software used to track inventory locations, quantities, and warehouse transactions.

LPN (License Plate Number): A unique barcode assigned to a pallet or inventory container for identification and tracking.

Step-by-Step Instructions

Step 1: Log In to the Scanner

Turn on the Honeywell CK65 scanner.

Enter your username and password.

Open the Warehouse Management System (WMS).

Step 2: Access the Cycle Count Menu

From the main menu, select Inventory.

Select Cycle Count.

Wait for the cycle count screen to load.

Step 3: Travel to the Assigned Location

Review the location displayed on the scanner.

Travel to the assigned warehouse location.

Verify that the location label matches the location shown on the scanner.

Warning: Counting inventory in the wrong location may create inventory discrepancies and require recounts.

Step 4: Scan the Location Barcode

Point the scanner at the location barcode.

Press the scan button.

Confirm the scanned location appears on the screen.

Step 5: Scan the LPN Barcode

Locate the pallet or inventory container.

Scan the LPN barcode attached to the pallet.

Verify that the correct LPN appears on the scanner screen.

Step 6: Physically Count the Inventory

Count all units stored in the location.

Count carefully and avoid estimating quantities.

Double-check any partial cases or damaged inventory according to company procedures.

Tip: Count from left to right and top to bottom to avoid missing inventory.

Step 7: Enter the Quantity

Type the physical quantity into the quantity field.

Compare the entered quantity with the actual inventory count.

Verify accuracy before proceeding.

Step 8: Submit the Count

Review the location, LPN, and quantity.

Select Submit Count.

Wait for the confirmation message.

Step 9: Review Results

If the quantity matches the system quantity:

• Accept the count.
• Proceed to the next assignment.

If the quantity does not match:

• Perform a recount.
• Verify all inventory in the location.
• Notify the inventory supervisor if the discrepancy remains.

Step 10: Continue Counting

Follow the scanner prompts to the next location.

Repeat the process until all assigned counts have been completed.

Troubleshooting Guide

Problem: Scanner Does Not Read Barcode

Possible Causes

• Damaged barcode
• Dirty barcode label
• Incorrect scanner angle

Solution

• Clean the barcode label.
• Move closer to the barcode.
• Adjust the scanner angle.
• Enter the barcode manually if authorized.

Problem: Quantity Does Not Match WMS

Possible Causes

• Miscounted inventory
• Inventory stored in the wrong location
• Data entry error

Solution

• Recount the inventory.
• Verify nearby locations.

• Check for additional pallets.
• Escalate unresolved discrepancies to the supervisor.

Problem: Incorrect Location Scanned

Solution

• Exit the transaction.
• Return to the assigned location.
• Rescan the correct location barcode.

User Testing and Revisions

To evaluate the effectiveness of these instructions, a coworker with limited cycle count experience was asked to follow the instructions exactly as written while performing a mock cycle count.

Feedback Received

The original instructions did not clearly indicate whether the location barcode or pallet barcode should be scanned first.

The tester was unsure what action to take when the physical count did not match the system quantity.

More visual guidance was requested to understand the overall process.

Revisions Made

Based on the feedback, the following improvements were made:

• Added definitions for technical terms such as LPN, Cycle Count, and WMS.
• Clarified that the location barcode must be scanned before the pallet barcode.
• Added a troubleshooting section for inventory discrepancies.
• Included warning and tip callout boxes to reduce user errors.
• Added a flowchart to provide a visual overview of the entire process.

These revisions improved the clarity, organization, and usability of the instructions.

Reflection

Testing the instructions with another user demonstrated the importance of evaluating technical documents from the perspective of the intended audience. Although the original instructions seemed clear to me because of my experience with inventory operations, the tester encountered several areas of confusion. Specifically, the tester did not understand the meaning of the term LPN and was uncertain about the order in which the location and pallet barcodes should be scanned.

To address this feedback, I revised the instructions by defining technical terms, clarifying the sequence of steps, and adding troubleshooting information for common problems. I also included a flowchart that visually summarizes the cycle count process. These changes improved readability and made the instructions easier to follow without additional explanation.

The testing process reinforced several technical writing best practices. First, instructions should never assume the user has prior knowledge of technical terminology. Second, procedures should be organized in a logical sequence and written using concise, direct language. Finally, visual aids such as flowcharts can significantly improve understanding by helping users see the overall process before performing individual tasks.

Overall, testing improved the effectiveness of the instructions by identifying areas where users could become confused. The final version is more user-friendly, accurate, and aligned with the principles of effective technical communication.